

mail of the week

The drive against spiritual leaders makes me believe that we are moving in the right direction. Most of these men are criminals, who enjoy all luxuries of life without any work, pay no taxes and misguide innocent people.

BHAGWATI OZA, on e-mail

Caste Bound

There was a time when Indians vied to project themselves as upper caste people and many even changed their second names ("Tribal War", June 9). Thanks to politicians like V.P. Singh, they now want to become Dalits. Why do these leaders insist on dividing us? Why can't we be one?

B.H. AGARWAL, Bhopal

The Gujar-Meena caste war cannot be seen in isolation. The problem lies with the opportunistic vote-bank politics being pursued by our political parties.

J. AKSHOBHYA, Mysore

After 60 years of Independence, politics and reservation have become two sides of the same coin. Everyone has forgotten that reservations were introduced to uplift the weaker sections of the society, not for petty gains of a few classes.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

It is unfortunate that the Gujjars have once again taken to violence to press for the inclusion of their community in the Scheduled Tribes' list. They do not meet the criteria for the said status. They are just using their clout to squeeze out the original beneficiaries.

A.VANI, Hyderabad

Every now and then, the genie of reservations comes out of the bottle to cause death and destruction. And this demon will keep on taking its deadly toll till the unethical policy of caste-based reservations is scrapped.

A.K. SHARMA, Chandigarh

State Terrorised

Instead of pussy-footing around to play votebank politics and appeasing minorities, our leaders must sit together and

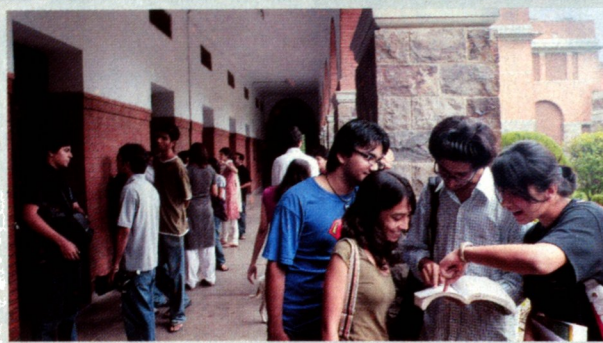
evolve a strong national policy against state-sponsored cross-border terrorism by devilish mercenaries masquerading as "jehadis" ("Nation in Denial", May 26). Why let our national pride suffer interminably?

G.S. KHIMTA, Shimla

The faceless terrorist is a coward. A bigger coward is the state and its leadership which does nothing to protect its citizens.

PRASHANTH KUMAR, Ohio, USA

FOR EDUCATION'S SAKE



I am surprised to see that year after year, the magazine has been projecting only those colleges which are situated in major metro cities ("India's Best Colleges", June 2). Probably, you are not aware that a number of colleges in small towns and rural areas are as good as those in the cities, if not better,

N. BALAKESAVAN, Mumbai

This is the best time to take out an issue like this as most students scout for good colleges around this time of the year. The story drives home the point that a sound education can help you achieve everything.

MAHESH KUMAR DADRWAL, Jaipur

INDIA TODAY's ranking of colleges is superfluous at best. For example, IITs are not only engineering institutes but research institutes as well. Moreover, a number of institutes that charge a high capitation fee have been put in the same list along with government-aided colleges.

BALAJI KRISHNAMURTHY, Ohio, USA

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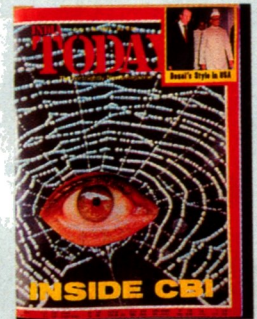
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Years Ago in India Today

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Emerging from Shadows

The arrest of Dr Jayanti Dharma Teja, former chairperson of Jayanti Shipping Company, by the CBI in 1970 and the dramatic hunt preceding it which took agency sleuths halfway across the globe, did more for the CBI's image than any other event in its previous history. His conviction in 1972 concluded the most widely-publicised success story of the agency that is referred to as "the longest arm of the law". When the CBI first stepped into the picture in



Teja December 1966, Teja had already slipped the country. Initial investigations through Interpol produced no clues. The first task was to gather enough evidence against the man, which surprisingly proved to be the easiest phase of the operation. Starting from Tokyo, the trail of Teja's financial fiddling took CBI to New York, London and Oslo. By this time, dogged investigations traced Teja to New York.

—Dilip Bobb and Asoka Raina